PADHAKU
India and the Contemporary World – II · Class 10 Social Science



CHAPTER 3

The Making of a Global World

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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💬 Discuss · Conquest, Disease and Trade

? Explain what we mean when we say that the world ‘shrank’ in the 1500s.

✔ ANSWER

In the sixteenth century, distant parts of the world came into regular contact for the first time, so the world seemed to become ‘smaller’.

- European sailors found a **sea route to Asia** and crossed the western ocean to **America**.
- America, cut off for millions of years, now became linked with Europe, Asia and Africa.
- Goods, crops (potato, maize, tomato), precious metals (silver from Peru and Mexico), people and even germs (smallpox) moved across oceans.
- The Indian Ocean trade was expanded and redirected towards Europe.

So travel and trade over long distances became regular, linking the whole world together.

🧪 Activity · A World Economy Takes Shape

1 Prepare a flow chart to show how Britain’s decision to import food led to increased migration to America and Australia.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Flow chart:

- Population and cities grow in Britain → demand for food grains rises → food prices go up
- ↓ Industrialists and urban dwellers force the **abolition of the Corn Laws**
- ↓ Cheap food is imported into Britain; British agriculture cannot compete
- ↓ Food prices fall, consumption and food imports rise
- ↓ Lands are cleared in Eastern Europe, Russia, America and Australia to grow food for Britain
- ↓ Railways, ports, homes and settlements are needed → capital flows from London
- ↓ Labour is short in America and Australia → demand for workers
- ↓ **Migration increases**: nearly 50 million people leave Europe for America and Australia

2 **Imagine that you are an agricultural worker who has arrived in America from Ireland. Write a paragraph on why you chose to come and how you are earning your living.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

I left my village in Ireland because life there had become impossible. When disease destroyed our potato crop in the 1840s, thousands of people around us died of hunger. After cheap grain began to be imported into Britain, farm work also became scarce and we could not earn enough. I heard that America had vast lands and needed workers, so I crossed the ocean on a crowded emigrant ship.

Now I work as a wage labourer on a large wheat farm that was a forest only a few years ago. I clear land, plough, sow and harvest the grain, which is carried by railway to the ports and shipped to Britain. The work is hard and the hours are long, but I earn regular wages, have enough to eat and hope to save money to buy a small farm of my own one day.

💬 Discuss · Indentured Labour Migration from India

? Discuss the importance of language and popular traditions in the creation of national identity.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Language and popular traditions give people a feeling that they belong to one community.

- A **common language** lets people share ideas, stories and history; it becomes a symbol of unity (e.g. use of the Polish language against Russian rule in Europe).

- **Folk songs, folk tales, dances and festivals** show the true spirit of the common people and are shared by all of them.
- Collecting folklore (e.g. the Grimm brothers in Germany) helped people discover a common past.
- Shared traditions also help a community keep its identity far from home, as Indian indentured workers did with ‘Hosay’ and ‘chutney music’ in the Caribbean.

Thus language and popular culture bind people together and help create a national identity.

💬 Discuss · India and the Great Depression

? Who profits from jute cultivation according to the jute growers’ lament? Explain.

✔ ANSWER

According to the lament, the **traders** (middlemen) profit from jute cultivation, not the growers.

- Peasants borrow money and work hard to grow more jute hoping for more cash.
- During the Depression gunny exports collapsed and raw jute prices fell by more than 60 per cent.
- The traders, ‘sitting at home’, pay the growers only **Rs 5 a maund**.

- So the growers' costs and debts rise, while traders buy cheaply and gain.

💬 Discuss · Post-war Settlement and the Bretton Woods Institutions

? Briefly summarise the two lessons learnt by economists and politicians from the inter-war economic experience.

✔ ANSWER

Lesson 1: An industrial society based on **mass production cannot last without mass consumption**. Mass consumption needs high and stable incomes, which need steady, full employment. Markets alone cannot ensure this, so **governments must step in** to reduce ups and downs of prices, output and employment.

Lesson 2: On links with the outside world, the goal of full employment can be reached only if **governments have the power to control flows of goods, capital and labour**.

⭐ Write in brief

1 Give two examples of different types of global exchanges which took place before the seventeenth century, choosing one example from Asia and one from the Americas.

✔ ANSWER

Asia – the silk routes: land and sea routes linked China and India with Europe and northern Africa. Chinese silk and pottery, Indian and Southeast Asian textiles and spices went west; gold and silver came to Asia. Religions like Buddhism, Christianity and Islam also spread along them.

Americas – food crops: after Columbus reached America, crops like potatoes, maize, tomatoes, chillies, groundnuts, soya and sweet potatoes came to Europe and Asia. Silver from Peru and Mexico also flowed to Europe.

2 **Explain how the global transfer of disease in the pre-modern world helped in the colonisation of the Americas.**

✔ ANSWER

- The Spanish and Portuguese conquerors carried germs such as **smallpox** on their bodies.
- America's original inhabitants had been isolated for a very long time, so they had **no immunity** against these European diseases.
- Smallpox spread deep into the continent, even ahead of the Europeans, and killed whole communities.
- Guns could be captured and used against invaders, but not diseases.

Thus germs proved the most powerful ‘weapon’ and paved the way for conquest.

3 (a) **Write a note to explain the effects of the British government’s decision to abolish the Corn Laws.**

✔ ANSWER

- Food could now be imported into Britain more cheaply than it could be grown there.
- British agriculture could not compete; vast areas of land were left uncultivated.
- Thousands of men and women lost work and moved to cities or migrated overseas.
- Food prices fell, consumption and food imports rose.
- Lands were cleared in Eastern Europe, Russia, America and Australia to grow food for Britain, and railways, ports and settlements were built with capital from London; labour migration increased.

3 (b) **The coming of rinderpest to Africa.**

✔ ANSWER

- Rinderpest, a cattle plague, came to East Africa in the late 1880s with infected cattle from British Asia.
- It spread west ‘like forest fire’ and killed **90 per cent of the cattle**.

- Loss of cattle destroyed African livelihoods based on land and livestock.
- Planters, mine owners and colonial governments took control of the remaining cattle and forced Africans into the labour market to work for wages.
- Control over cattle helped Europeans conquer and subdue Africa.

3 (c) **The death of men of working-age in Europe because of the World War.**

✔ ANSWER

- About 9 million people died and 20 million were injured; most were men of working age.
- This reduced the **able-bodied workforce** in Europe.
- With fewer earning members in families, **household incomes declined** after the war.
- Women had to take up jobs that earlier only men did.

3 (d) **The Great Depression on the Indian economy.**

✔ ANSWER

- India's exports and imports **nearly halved** between 1928 and 1934.
- Prices crashed: wheat prices fell by 50 per cent; raw jute prices fell by more than 60 per cent.

- The colonial government refused to reduce revenue demands, so peasants fell deeper into debt; they used up savings, mortgaged land and sold jewellery.
- India became an exporter of gold, which helped Britain's recovery but not the peasant.
- Rural unrest grew (civil disobedience movement, 1931).
- Urban people with fixed incomes became better off, and industrial investment grew due to tariff protection.

3 (e) **The decision of MNCs to relocate production to Asian countries.**

✔ ANSWER

- From the late 1970s MNCs shifted production to **low-wage Asian countries** such as China.
- This stimulated **world trade and capital flows**.
- Countries like India, China and Brazil saw rapid economic transformation; goods like TVs, mobile phones and toys came to be made cheaply in China.
- The industrial world faced job losses and unemployment remained high.

4 **Give two examples from history to show the impact of technology on food availability.**

✔ ANSWER

1. Railways and ships: railways linked farming regions to ports, and larger ships and lighter wagons carried food cheaply and quickly from faraway farms in America and Australia to Europe, so cheap food became available to more people.

2. Refrigerated ships: till the 1870s animals were shipped live, which was costly, so meat was a luxury. Refrigerated ships allowed animals to be slaughtered in America, Australia or New Zealand and sent as frozen meat. Meat prices fell and the poor in Europe could add meat, butter and eggs to their diet.

5 **What is meant by the Bretton Woods Agreement?**

✔ ANSWER

- It was the framework of the post-war international economic system agreed at the **United Nations Monetary and Financial Conference, July 1944, at Bretton Woods** (New Hampshire, USA).
- Aim: to preserve economic stability and full employment in the industrial world.

- It set up the **IMF** (to deal with external surpluses and deficits of members) and the **World Bank** (IBRD, to finance post-war reconstruction).
- It was based on **fixed exchange rates**: national currencies were pegged to the dollar, and the dollar to gold at $35 per ounce.

💬 Discuss

6 **Imagine that you are an indentured Indian labourer in the Caribbean. Drawing from the details in this chapter, write a letter to your family describing your life and feelings.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Trinidad, 1905

Dear Mother and Father,

I hope you are well. I miss you and our village in Bihar very much. The agent who brought me here told us the work would be easy and the pay good, but he did not tell the truth. We crossed the sea for many weeks in a crowded ship.

Here I work on a cocoa plantation from dawn to dusk. The tasks given to us are very heavy and new workers cannot finish them in a day. Money is cut from our wages if the work is thought poor, and if we fall ill and miss work we can be punished or even jailed. We have few rights; the employers know us by our numbers, not our names.

Still, we help each other. Workers of all religions join together in the Hosay procession at Muharram, and we sing songs of home. My contract is for five years, after which I may return. I am trying to save a little money. Please pray for me.

Your loving son,

Ramu

7 **Explain the three types of movements or flows within international economic exchange. Find one example of each type of flow which involved India and Indians, and write a short account of it.**

✔ ANSWER

Economists identify three flows:

1. **Flow of trade** – mainly trade in goods such as cloth or wheat.

2. **Flow of labour** – migration of people in search of employment.

3. **Flow of capital** – movement of money for short-term or long-term investment over long distances.

Examples involving India:

- **Trade:** In the 19th century India exported raw cotton, indigo, food grains and opium (to China) and imported British manufactured cloth. Britain's trade surplus with India helped it balance its deficits with other countries.
- **Labour:** Indentured labourers from eastern UP, Bihar, central India and Tamil Nadu went to work on plantations in the Caribbean (Trinidad, Guyana, Surinam), Mauritius, Fiji, Ceylon, Malaya and Assam.
- **Capital:** Indian bankers like the Shikaripuri Shroffs and Nattukottai Chettiars financed export agriculture in Central and Southeast Asia with their own funds or loans from European banks.

8 **Explain the causes of the Great Depression.**

✔ ANSWER

The Great Depression began around 1929 and lasted till the mid-1930s. Its main causes were:

1. **Agricultural overproduction:** as prices fell, farmers produced even more to keep their income, which caused a glut and pushed prices down further; produce rotted for lack of buyers.

2. **Dependence on US loans:** many countries financed investments with US loans. When trouble began, US lenders panicked; overseas loans fell from over $1 billion (first half of 1928) to a quarter of that a year later.

3. **Effects of withdrawal of loans:** major banks failed in Europe and currencies like the British pound collapsed; in Latin America the slump in farm and raw material prices worsened.

4. **US protectionism:** the US doubled import duties, dealing a severe blow to world trade.

5. **Collapse of US banking:** US banks cut lending and called back loans; households could not repay, businesses collapsed, over 4,000 banks closed by 1933 and about 110,000 companies collapsed (1929–32).

Thus a fragile post-war economy turned into a worldwide depression.

9 **Explain what is referred to as the G-77 countries. In what ways can G-77 be seen as a reaction to the activities of the Bretton Woods twins?**

✔ ANSWER

G-77: the Group of 77 is a group of developing countries that organised themselves to demand a **New International Economic Order (NIEO)**.

As a reaction to the Bretton Woods twins (IMF and World Bank):

- The IMF and World Bank were designed to meet the financial needs of industrial countries, not to fight poverty in former colonies.
- Decision-making in them was controlled by Western industrial powers; the US had an effective veto.
- Newly independent countries came under the guidance of agencies dominated by former colonial powers, who still controlled their minerals and land.
- Developing countries did not benefit from the fast growth of Western economies in the 1950s–60s.
- So through the NIEO, G-77 demanded real control over their natural resources, more development assistance, fairer prices for raw materials and better access for their manufactured goods in developed countries' markets.

🛠️ Project

1 **Find out more about gold and diamond mining in South Africa in the nineteenth century. Who controlled the gold and diamond companies? Who were the miners and what were their lives like?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Model project outline:

- **Discovery:** diamonds were found near Kimberley (1860s) and gold in the Witwatersrand, Transvaal (1886). By the 1890s South Africa produced over 20 per cent of the world's gold.
- **Who controlled:** European (mainly British) capitalists and companies, e.g. Cecil Rhodes and De Beers in diamonds, and big mining houses in Johannesburg, backed by colonial governments.
- **Who were the miners:** mostly black African workers, many forced into wage work by heavy taxes, loss of land and loss of cattle (rinderpest); some migrant labourers from nearby regions.
- **Their lives:** low wages, long hours, dangerous work deep underground, diseases; workers were kept in closed **compounds** and not allowed to move freely; white workers got better jobs and pay.
- Add pictures (e.g. Figs. 12 and 13 of the chapter), a map of the mining areas and a short conclusion on how mining linked Africa to the world economy.

🎉 **Chapter 3 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**